

Valéria Vieira dos Santos

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

PhD Candidate in Linguistics (UFSCar) specializing in LLM evaluation and computational pragmatics, with 6+ years of industry experience in Conversational AI. Research focus: calibration of language models using oral language phenomena as evaluation signal.

Research Interests: Computational Linguistics, Natural Language Processing (NLP), Conversational AI, Prompt Engineering, eXplainable AI (XAI) in Social NLP.

WORK EXPERIENCE

AI Project Manager / Customer Experience Manager – Serasa Experian, São Paulo, Brazil Aug 2022 – Aug 2025

- Achieved a 4.7 CSAT and led digital transformation projects, successfully migrating customer service channels from 80% voice to 70% digital, significantly boosting operational efficiency.
- Managed the design and implementation of large-scale Conversational AI solutions (chatbots and virtual assistants) to optimize operational efficiency.

Conversational Intelligence Coordinator / Chapter Lead – Blip, Belo Horizonte, Brazil Aug 2021 – Aug 2022

- Led multidisciplinary squads in developing and optimizing AI agents for clients such as Netflix, Claro, and Globoplay.
- Responsible for linguistic data curation, definition of intents/entities, and validation of training corpora for NLP systems, with a focus on scalability.

Founder / Conversational AI Specialist – Langue, São Carlos, Brazil 2018 – 2021

- Led the development of bespoke chatbot and voicebot solutions for small and medium-sized enterprises.
- Responsible for the complete project lifecycle, from initial client consultation and design to deployment and performance analysis.

TEACHING & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Specialization in Didactic-Pedagogical Processes for Distance Learning Courses – UNIVESP (in partnership with UFSCar) Feb 2026 – Est. Duration: 2 years

- Enrolled in Specialization in Distance Education and Pedagogical Practices.
- Role as Paid Facilitator: Responsible for mediation, correction, and student support in the Virtual Learning Environment (VLE/AVA), dedicating 12 hours/week (4h theoretical and 8h practical) to teacher training and practice.

Supervised Teaching Capacity Building Internship (PESCD) – Federal University of São Carlos 2025

- Teaching Internship in an Undergraduate discipline (Lab 8), focused on Linguistics/Research Area.
- Activities: Conducted an expository class, provided direct assistance to students in daily activities, and participated fully in classes, under the supervision of the faculty member in charge.

RESEARCH PROJECTS

PhD Research: LLM Calibration & Hallucination Federal University of São Carlos (UFSCar)

Investigating the correlation between the suppression of pragmatic markers (hesitations) and semantic hallucinations in LLMs (GPT-4, Sabiá-2). Developing a contrastive benchmark using the **Roda Viva Corpus** to audit model overconfidence through **Expected Calibration Error (ECE)** and semantic entropy metrics. (2025 – Present)

International Research Intern University of West Bohemia, Czech Republic

Conducted fundamental research on Prompt Engineering to evaluate the suitability and accuracy of Large Language Models (LLMs) in specialized tasks. Demonstrated strong interdisciplinary research capabilities, connecting linguistic methodologies with technical terminology. (Jan 2025 – Apr 2025)

Master’s Thesis ResearchFederal University of São Carlos (UFSCar)

Investigated the role of hesitation in human-machine communication, identifying it as a crucial pragmatic marker. The research aimed to model linguistic features that create a sense of "humanity" and coherence in dialogues to improve relational effectiveness. URL: <https://repositorio.ufscar.br/items/50de...> (2023 – 2025)

EDUCATION

2025 - Present	PhD in Linguistics, Federal University of São Carlos (UFSCar) - Brazil
2026 - Present	Specialization in Applied Statistics, Anhanguera Focus: Quantitative methods and statistical modeling for NLP.
2023 - 2025	Master of Arts (M.A.) in Linguistics, Federal University of São Carlos (UFSCar) - Brazil (GPA: 3.8/4.0)
2019 - 2020	MBA in Business Management, University of São Paulo (USP/ESALQ)
2015 - 2018	Bachelor of Arts (B.A.) in Linguistics, Federal University of São Carlos (UFSCar) - Brazil

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Santos, Valéria Vieira dos (2025). “Hesitação e Humanização em Chatbots: Uma Análise Linguística”. In: *Linguasagem* 43.1. ISSN: 1983-6988. URL: <https://www.linguasagem.ufscar.br/index.php/linguasagem/article/view/1794>.

Santos, Valéria Vieira dos and Miroslav Malaga (2025). “A Methodology for Prompt Engineering in Engineering: Framework Development and Performance Evaluation”. In: *Proceedings of the Industrial Engineering 2025 Conference*. Plzeň, Czech Republic: University of West Bohemia. ISBN: 978-80-261-1328-7. URL: <https://dspace.zcu.cz/items/3bbe45e3-53ba-46b3-a60b-84062c5a86cf>.

Santos, Valéria Vieira dos (2026a). “Extracting Behavioral Patterns from Conversational Data: A Comparative Study of Human and AI Hesitation for Knowledge Management”. In: *Proceedings of LPKM 2026*. Accepted for presentation.

Santos, Valéria Vieira dos (2026b). “Speech Disfluencies and LLM Calibration: A Pilot Study on the Effects of Textual Sanitization in Brazilian Portuguese”. In: *2nd Joint Workshop on Discourse and Dialogue (CODI-CRAC 2026)*, co-located with *ACL 2026*. Under review.

SKILLS

AI & NLP	Statistical Model Evaluation (ECE) , LLM Benchmarking, Prompt Engineering (Expert), Natural Language Inference (NLI), Computational Pragmatics, Linguistic Data Strategy.
Tools	Dialogflow, Rasa, Microsoft Bot Framework, TensorFlow, PyTorch, Scikit-Learn, Statsmodels , SciPy .
Programming	Python (Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, Seaborn) : Advanced data analysis, statistical scripting for NLP, and automated evaluation pipelines.

LANGUAGES

Proficiency Portuguese (Native), English (Fluent — TOEIC 755), Spanish (Advanced), French (Intermediate).

REFERENCES

Prof. Dr. Oto Araújo do Vale	PhD’s Thesis Advisor, UFSCar, otovale@ufscar.br
Prof. Ing. Miroslav Malaga, Ph.D.	Research Internship Supervisor, University of West Bohemia, malaga@kpv.zcu.cz
Renato Ciccarelli	Customer Care Director, Serasa Experian, renato.ciccarelli@experian.com